22.9.2 CPCSEA

CPCSEA stands for 'The Committee for the Purpose of Control and Supervision of Experiments on Animals'. It is a statutory committee set up under the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act, 1960. It has been functioning since 1991 to ensure that animals are not subjected to unnecessary suffering during experiments on them.

Objectives of CPCSEA

i) To avoid unnecessary pain before and after experiment.

ii) To promote the human care of animal used in experiments.

iii) To provide guidelines for animal housing, breeding and maintenances.

iv) To promote the human care of animal used in biomedical and behavioural research and testing.

Functions of CPCSEA

i) Approval of animal house facilities.

ii) Permission for conducting experiments involving usage of animals

iii) Action against establishments in case of established violation

iv) Registration of establishments conducting animal experimentation or breeding of animals for this purpose.

Points to Remember

- Human activities which are responsible for deforestation include agricultural expansion, cattle breeding, illegal logging, mining, oil extraction, dam construction and infrastructure development.
- Afforestation helps the wild animals and even humans to have shelter and to find their food source.
- Reforestation will revive the watersheds which are important aspects of environmental well-being.
- Snow leopard, Bengal tiger, Asiatic Lion, Purple frog and Indian giant squirrel are some of the endangered animals in India.
- For maintaining healthy ecological balance on this earth, animal and plant species are important.
- Red Data Book gives important data for observational studies and monitoring programmes on habits and habitats of rare and endangered species.
- Conservation of biodiversity helps us to protect, maintain and recover endangered animals and plant species.
- When the organisms in the higher food chain feed on the organisms in the lower food chain containing these toxins, these toxins get accumulated in the higher organisms.

A-Z GLOSSARY

Biodiversity	Variety of life forms.
Bio magnification	Increasing concentration of substances such as toxic chemical in the tissues of organism at successively higher level in a food chain.
Deforestation	Removal of forest.
Extinct species	Species which have disappeared completely from the earth.
Endangered species	A species of plant or animal that is in immediate danger of biological extinction.
Endemic species	Plants and animals species that are found only in a particular area.
Flora	Plant life occurring in a particular region.
Fauna	Animal life occurring in a particular region.
National Park	Protected area of land in which a typical ecosystem with all its wild plants and animals are protected and preserved in natural surroundings.

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